

Reading

Reading

My Best Friend, Zeynep

Before you read

- Look at the title. What information do you think the text will include about Zeynep?
- Guess: what three adjectives might describe a good friend?

My name is Aslı and I want to tell you about my best friend, Zeynep. We are in the same class, and we get on well with each other. Zeynep is fourteen years old, and she has long curly brown hair and big brown eyes.

Zeynep isn't very tall, but she is quite slim and always looks stylish. She usually wears comfortable clothes, like jeans and a stripy jumper, but today she is wearing a spotted dress for a school photo.

As for her personality, Zeynep is very cheerful and generous. She always shares her lunch with me, and she never gets angry, even when things go wrong. She's also hard-working — she studies every evening after school.

Zeynep isn't shy at all. She loves talking to new people, and she gets on well with everyone in our class. The only thing is, she can be a little stubborn — when she decides something, she doesn't change her mind easily!

I'm really lucky to have a friend like Zeynep. She always makes me laugh, and I know I can trust her with anything.

1. What is the text mainly about?
 - a. A description of Aslı's best friend
 - b. A description of a school trip
 - c. How to make new friends
2. What colour is Zeynep's hair?
 - a. Straight and black
 - b. Curly and brown
 - c. Short and blonde
3. What is Zeynep wearing today?
 - a. Jeans and a stripy jumper
 - b. A spotted dress
 - c. A school uniform
4. In paragraph 3, what does 'her' refer to?
 - a. Aslı's
 - b. Zeynep's
 - c. the teacher's
5. Zeynep gets angry very often. — *True / False*

6. What is one thing that makes Zeynep stubborn?

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- a. She never changes her mind once she decides something
 - b. She doesn't like new people
 - c. She doesn't do her homework

After you read

- Write two sentences describing your own best friend's appearance.
- Compare Zeynep with your best friend. Find one similarity and one difference.

How to Write a Great Fact File

Before you read

- What do you think a 'fact file' about a person includes? Guess two things.
- Have you ever interviewed someone? What questions did you ask?

A fact file is a short text that gives information about a person. At the end of Theme 3, you are going to interview a classmate and write a fact file about them, so let's look at a good example first.

This is Deniz's fact file, written by his classmate Mert: 'Deniz is fifteen years old. He is tall and has short straight hair and dark brown eyes. He usually wears casual clothes, like a hoodie and trainers, because he thinks they are comfortable.'

Mert continues: 'Deniz's personality is easy to describe — he is friendly, cheerful and very generous. He always helps his classmates with their homework, and he gets on well with everyone in our year. He isn't shy at all!'

Notice how Mert uses the Simple Present for facts (he is, he wears) and clear vocabulary for appearance and personality. He also organises the fact file into two parts: appearance first, then personality.

When you write your own fact file, remember to interview your classmate carefully, take notes, and use a mix of appearance and personality words. Don't forget to check your grammar before you present it to the class!

1. What is the text mainly about?

- a. How to plan a school trip
- b. How to write a good fact file about a person
- c. The history of interviews

2. Who wrote the example fact file?

- a. Deniz
- b. Mert
- c. The teacher

3. What does Deniz usually wear?

- a. A suit and smart shoes
- b. A hoodie and trainers
- c. A stripy shirt

4. Which tense does Mert mainly use in the fact file?

- a. Present Progressive
- b. Past Simple
- c. Simple Present

5. The fact file only describes Deniz's appearance, not his personality. — *True / False*

6. According to the text, what should you do before presenting your fact file?

- a. Translate it into Turkish
- b. Check your grammar
- c. Make it as long as possible

After you read

- List three questions you could ask a classmate for your own fact file interview.
- Which two personality adjectives would you like someone to use about you? Why?